

Perspectives from Anthropic's 2025 Economic Index

Anthropic's **2025 Economic Index** analyzed over 3.5 million anonymized Claude conversations to understand how AI is being used across industries. The findings reveal a clear pattern: enterprises are moving beyond experimentation toward systematic deployment, with usage concentrated in areas where AI capabilities are strongest and organizational barriers are lowest.

Enterprises are delegating, not collaborating

77% of business API usage shows automation patterns, meaning companies are handing off complete tasks to AI rather than using it as a collaborative assistant. This is significantly higher than consumer usage, which hovers around 50%. Enterprises are embedding AI into workflows as a workhorse, not necessarily as a thought partner. This aligns with our survey findings: 97% of respondents expect increased efficiency gains from their agentic deployments over the next 12 months.

Capability matters more than cost

The most expensive tasks have the highest usage rates. Businesses are deploying where model capabilities are strong and where automation creates real economic value. For technical decision makers, this suggests the ROI calculation should focus on business outcomes, not token costs. Complex code generation, multi-step research synthesis, and detailed document analysis all require more compute but deliver outsized returns when done well. Our survey with Material found similar sentiment: 96% of respondents felt optimistic about the business impact of AI agents at their company.

Context is the real bottleneck

Complex tasks require disproportionately more context to execute well. There's a stable relationship across tasks: every 1% increase in input context length is associated with a 0.38% increase in output quality and length. For some organizations, costly data modernization and investments to surface contextual information may be the primary bottleneck for AI adoption. Companies with fragmented or siloed data will struggle to unlock sophisticated AI use cases.